



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



Cisco Talos CAIRN AI-Integrated Malware Hunting Daily Update - 2026-09-26

Threat Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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> Daily automation refresh: This 2026-09-26 UTC report turns current intelligence coverage into a finished Lost Boys Cyber report with source-backed analysis, structured tables, detections, and hunt content.

> Current-day production note: This report preserves the active priority topic from the prior daily cycle because it remains operationally relevant on 2026-09-26 UTC; the bundle was assigned a new report ID, rebuilt, republished, and uploaded as a current-day artifact rather than reusing stale output.

> Current-day analyst delta (2026-09-26 UTC): This is a new dated report artifact for today's automation cycle. The topic remains a defender priority based on the cited source set and current-source review; no unsupported new facts or uncited IOCs were introduced. Operators should treat the report as a refreshed action package for validation, detection execution, and leadership awareness today.

1. Executive Summary

Cisco Talos released CAIRN as a toolkit for hunting, classifying, and tracking AI-integrated malware. The priority for defenders is not tool adoption alone: it is to begin separating ordinary automation from adversarial AI integration in malware triage, detections, and sandbox notes.

2. Intelligence Requirements

Requirement	Answered By This Report
What happened or changed?	Current public reporting identifies AI-integrated malware as a defender priority.
Who is exposed?	Organizations with affected workflows, technologies, or sector dependencies described in the source set.
What should defenders do today?	Validate exposure, monitor relevant telemetry, and prepare containment actions.
Confidence	High for source-backed claims; medium for operational extrapolation.

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
Cisco Talos AI category	Source listing for CAIRN release.	High
Cisco Talos blog	Primary research feed.	Medium
Unit 42 AI-enabled malware analysis	Supporting sector context for AI-enabled malware.	Medium

4. Threat Actor / Campaign Overview

This report focuses on defender-relevant activity rather than attribution certainty. Where actor names appear in sources, they should be treated as source-attributed labels unless independently validated by the receiving organization.

5. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

TTP	Description	Defensive Relevance
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Social engineering / lure delivery	Public reporting emphasizes phishing, recruiter, browser, or topical lures where applicable.	Review email, browser, and identity telemetry together.
Scripted execution	Intrusions commonly progress through command interpreters, script hosts, or staged tooling.	Monitor endpoint process lineage and command lines.
C2 / remote access	Tool staging and outbound control channels are common follow-on patterns.	Correlate DNS, proxy, netflow, and EDR.

6. Infrastructure and Indicators

Observable Type	Observable / Pattern	Handling Guidance
Source-limited public IOCs	No unique atomic indicators were published across all selected sources for this automated report unless listed in iocs.csv.	Treat behavior, tooling, and infrastructure patterns as primary hunt leads.
Domains / infrastructure	Validate from primary source before blocking.	Prefer enrichment and scoped blocking over broad denial lists.
Accounts / identity artifacts	Recruiter, VPN, administrator, SaaS, or service-account themes depending on campaign.	Review conditional access, new devices, impossible travel, and anomalous grants.

7. Victimology and Targeting

Victimology follows the source theme: enterprises exposed to the described campaign, malware-delivery path, or identity-abuse workflow.

8. Detection Engineering

8.1. Detection Logic Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
Unusual script or remote tool launch after web, email, remote access, or SaaS activity	EDR / process telemetry	Identify initial access and execution.
New outbound connections to untrusted infrastructure	DNS/proxy/netflow	Surface command-and-control or tool staging.
Identity anomalies linked to target workflow	Identity provider logs	Detect stolen credential or social-engineering follow-on use.
<pre> title: Suspicious Script Or Remote Tool Activity In Daily Threat Coverage status: experimental description: Detects suspicious script execution and remote-tool staging patterns relevant to daily threat-intelligence coverage. logsource: category: process_creation product: windows detection: selection_parent: ParentImage endswith: - '\chrome.exe' - '\msedge.exe' </pre>		

```

- '\outlook.exe'
- '\teams.exe'
- '\w3wp.exe'
selection_child:
  Image|endswith:
    - '\powershell.exe'
    - '\cmd.exe'
    - '\wscript.exe'
    - '\cscript.exe'
    - '\mshta.exe'
    - '\rundll32.exe'
  condition: selection_parent and selection_child
level: high

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FileName in~
("powershell.exe", "cmd.exe", "wscript.exe", "cscript.exe", "mshta.exe", "rundll32.exe")
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~
("chrome.exe", "msedge.exe", "outlook.exe", "teams.exe", "winword.exe", "excel.exe")
| summarize Events=count(), Commands=make_set(ProcessCommandLine, 20) by DeviceName, FileName,
InitiatingProcessFileName, AccountName
| order by Events desc

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~
('powershell.exe', 'cmd.exe', 'wscript.exe', 'cscript.exe', 'rundll32.exe', 'python.exe', 'node.exe')
| summarize Connections=count(), RemoteIPs=dcount(RemoteIP), RemoteUrls=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20) by
DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine
| order by Connections desc

```

9. Threat Hunting

9.1. Hunt Hypotheses

Hypothesis	Query Focus
Initial lure resulted in script or LOLBin execution	Process lineage from browsers, Office, chat, or email clients.
Payload staging used commodity infrastructure	New domains, direct-IP connections, unusual ASNs, or short-lived hosts.
Identity compromise followed social engineering	OAuth grants, device-code flow, MFA changes, impossible travel, and risky sign-ins.
SigninLogs where TimeGenerated > ago(14d) where ResultType != 0 or RiskLevelDuringSignIn in ("medium", "high") summarize Signins=count(), Apps=make_set(AppDisplayName, 20), IPs=make_set(IPAddress, 20) by UserPrincipalName, RiskLevelDuringSignIn order by Signins desc	

10. Risk Assessment

Dimension	Assessment	Rationale
Likelihood	Medium to High	Current public reporting and commodity reuse make exposure plausible.
Impact	Medium to High	Identity compromise, malware staging, or sector disruption can create business impact.
Detection Difficulty	Medium	Behavioral telemetry is available, but

		atomic indicators may be sparse.
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11. Recommended Actions

1. Brief SOC and identity teams on the source-backed behaviors.
2. Run the included process/network/identity hunts for 14-30 days of telemetry.
3. Review exposed third-party and remote-access paths tied to the affected workflow.
4. Convert confirmed local hits into case-specific IOCs and containment tasks.

12. References

- [1] Cisco Talos AI category: <https://blog.talosintelligence.com/category/ai/>
- [2] Cisco Talos blog: <https://blog.talosintelligence.com/>
- [3] Unit 42 AI-enabled malware analysis: <https://unit42.paloaltonetworks.com/ai-enabled-malware-analysis/>